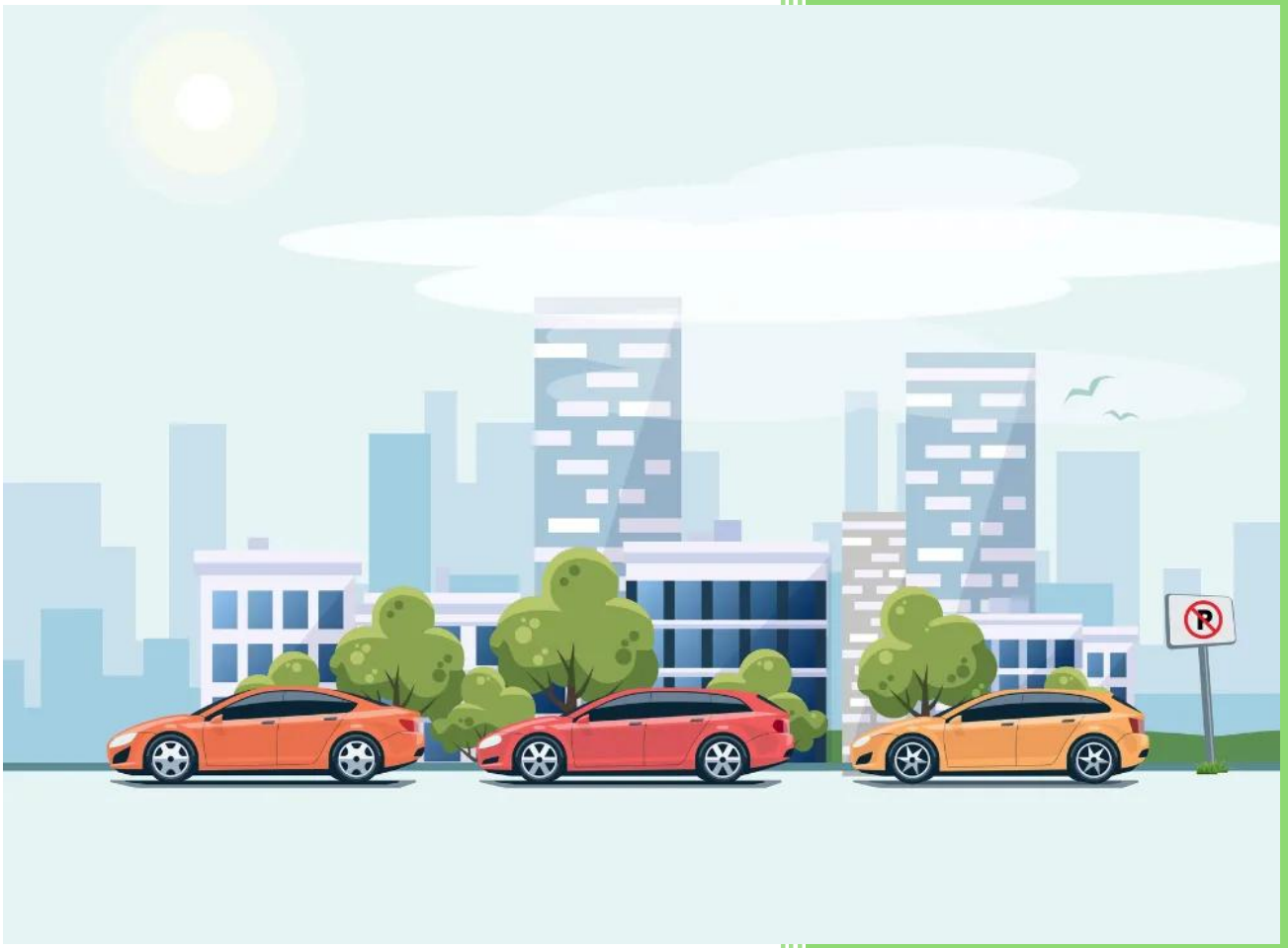
40% increase user Adoption of sRide App



Pushpa Prajapati

sRIDE is a carpooling mobile application to connect people within the community to share rides. sRide is available in major Indian cities including Chennai, Bangalore, Pune, Mumbai, Kolkata, Hyderabad, Delhi, Coimbatore, Jaipur, Nagpur, Ahmedabad and Kochi.

Why sRide is Needed?

sRide is specifically designed for daily commute of corporate employees. This will help users share the cost of travel, reduce travel time, increase mobility and build communities. For cities and organisations, it helps to use the existing infrastructure, reduce parking needs, traffic and emissions.

How sRide Works

Car/bike owner: Posts the source and destination points date and time of travel and the number of seats available to be filled up with the charge per seat.

Search Ride: Rider enters boarding and destination point and select travel date and time to find available carpooling rides.

Choose Best Match: Compare rides by price, departure time, and car owner ratings to find your best option.

Book Securely: Book and pay for your seat online. No cash needed.

Travel Together: Meet car owner at the pickup point, share the journey, and save money while reducing emissions.

Impact

Every shared ride contributes to a larger positive impact on our environment and communities. Here's how sRide is making a difference:

2M+
Happy Users
Across India

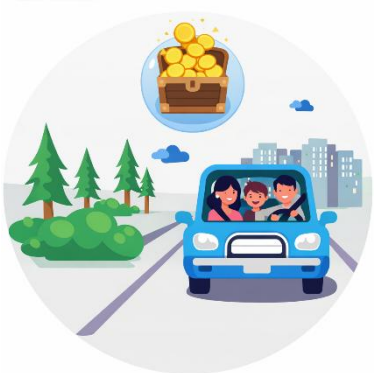
500K+
Completed Rides
And counting

₹85M+
User Savings
On travel costs

90,000 Tonnes
CO2 Saved

Why use Carpool?

- Saves approx. **80% of travel cost** spent per month on commute compared to travelling in solo cabs.
- Travelling in carpool with other professionals from different domain and company **expands professional network** while commuting.
- Carpooling **reduces traffic, pollution** and parking congestion into organization.



Market Competitors

ToGo

Quick Ride
Carpool • Taxi

POOLit

Green Car
Ride Together, Breathe Better

Key Features

Must Have	Should Have	Nice to Have
Verified riders & Drivers	Strong customer support	Penalties for cancellation/ no shows for the rides.
Call & chat option between rider & Driver	3 to 4 passengers for car pooling	SOS and Live tracking of the rides.
Rider opting for single ride in a time slot.	Option to select taxi, car or bike pooling.	Freemium access
Verified registered vehicles and driver having driving license.	Payment between rider and driver to be done using app.	Rewards & discounts
Instant matching rides for riders.	Auto suggestions for available rides in case of cancellation of booked ride.	AI generated convenient route.

User Personas

Lavanya (Female -28 yrs)

Lavanya works in a corporate firm and daily travels to office. She often travels by public transport but it's very hectic and tiring to travel by public transport during peak hours.
Lavanya owns a car and she gets to know about the sRide Application where the rides can be shared among working employees travelling on the same route to share the cost of travel, reduce travel time, increase mobility and build communities.

Pain Points

- Pickup/drop point mismatch.
- Fear of traveling with strangers.
- Fake profiles or incomplete verification.
- No-shows without penalties.
- Delay and disputes in Payment clearance for the rides.
- Low accountability for bad behaviour.
- Woman safety ride standard.

Needs/Goals to Achieve

- Clear pickup and drop points.
- Safe Traveling with complete KYC.
- Penalties for the No-shows
- Reviews & ratings for the riders given by driver.
- Customization & Rewards.

Ankush (Male – 26yrs)

Ankush's job requires him to commute daily. He uses public buses and auto-rickshaws, but they are often unreliable and uncomfortable for his long commutes. So, he uses sRide application for going to office with corporate community. But as a rider he is facing some challenges in using the application.

Pain Points

- Pickup/drop point mismatch.
- Mandatory subscription plans with limited rides.
- Last minute cancellation of posted ride.
- Unsure about driver's behaviour.
- Timing uncertainty to find ride.
- Account blocking without proper explanation.
- Poor customer support.

Needs/Goals to Achieve

- Flexible pickup windows and smart pickup point for common riders.
- Cancellation penalties.
- Reliability score for the driver and rider.
- Backup ride suggestions instantly after cancellation of ride.
- Import customer support for timely resolution of customer queries.

Here we will be focusing on below two problems for finding out possible solutions:

1) Pickup/Drop location mismatch.
2) Mandatory subscription plans.

Deep Dive into Problems

1. Pickup/Drop location mismatch

Driver posts the pick up and drop off location as per his destination. Riders get the notification of the pick up and the last drop off point but, rider has following concerns:

- The **exact coordinates** of pick up and drop off point is **not reflecting on the map.**
- Driver **modifies the pick up or drop off location** and the update notification is not delivered to the rider.
- Rider expects the **pickup and drop off to be done from residence and office** respectively while the pickup location of ride is by main road.
- **Travelling route** between pickup and drop off points is not described while posting the ride. So, the riders are not sure if the ride is on the same route and would be suitable for them to schedule.

These problems lead to unnecessary hustles and miscommunication between driver and rider resulting in cancellation or not opting for the pooling rides. Users start thinking of private rides.

2. Mandatory Subscription model

The most common complaints of user are about the mandatory subscription. Driver and riders can't utilize the app without taking subscription. Users have been raising concerns about:

- **Not finding any matching ride** on their route after opting the subscription.
- **Riders getting fake notifications about the posted ride** and when they request for the ride by paying subscription, they realise that ride doesn't exists.
- **Users hesitate to take subscription without actually using app**, as they can't trust if they would really find the rides.

- **No clear information or guide for the renewal of subscription model**. As most of the user gets frustrated and feel they have been preyed upon with auto renewal of the subscription.
- **Riders and drivers working in Hybrid model** doesn't find suitable to pay for all together 12 or 15 weeks. As they need to travel only 2 or 3 days a week.

These concerns lead to loosing trust, conversion & long-term retention. Users moving to other platforms where mandatory subscription is not required.

Possible solutions

1. Pickup/Drop location mismatch

There are some of possible solutions to overcome the pickup and drop off location mismatches between drivers and riders.

- **Locating the exact** starting and ending **points** of the ride **on map** with clear **address**.
- **Updating the ride details as and when driver updates** or modifies anything related to ride for e.g. date, time, travelling route, pick up or drop off location. Notification about the same should be sent to all riders who opted for the ride.
- **AI route prediction and confirmation from the driver.** Allow AI to predict and suggest all the possible routes between pick up and drop off point when driver is posting the ride. Driver can select the best possible and convenient route. So, whenever riders are checking for the available rides, they can also check for their convenient route and opt for the ride.
- **AI Enabled smart pick-up point.** After the riders have opted for the ride checking their convenient route, AI can fix a common smart pick-up point (CSP) for all the riders so that all the riders can meet up at the same time on that CSP.
- **The common smart pick point can be between 200 to 300m from their actual residence.**

Introducing health monitor feature & Reward Scheme for riders: A health monitoring feature to motivate Riders for walking 200 to 300m of distance to reach at common smart pick-up point, users will be notified about the number of steps they walked or the amount of calorie they have burnt while walking towards the common smart pick-up point and will get rewarded in the form of coins or stars which can be used in next rides for getting discounts.

2. Mandatory Subscription model

Mandatory Subscription model has primarily led to loosing trust, reduced conversion rates & decreased long-term retention. Some of the possible solutions to gain trust of customers and increase retention are:

- **Introduce Freemium access.** Offering the first 4 rides without subscription will acts as a marketing tool to encourage user adoption and build trust. Charges for first 4 rides to be included with 5% to 7% commission as service charge or platform fees. After 4 rides user to opt for subscription and need not pay service charge. Users will experience value for subscription.
- **Corporate partnerships.** Increasing corporate subscriptions instead of individual subscriptions will increase conversions. Company to partnership with corporate firms and take subscription on behalf of employers in order to provide conveyance which will be led by employers only. This will increase their professional bonding and cross connections with people working in different domains.
- Introducing **15 days or 30 days subscription** plans with 11 rides or 27 rides for the users travelling to office working in hybrid model.
- Launching **detailed FAQs and prompt response customer support** for addressing the queries and issues related to subscription model.
- In case of last-minute cancellation of rides, **auto suggestion of rides available** on same route in same time slot to be notified.

Wireframes

AI Route Suggestions
Fastest
Shortest
Scenic
Toll-Free
Route A (AI Top Pisk)
ETA: 45 min
Distsnce: 25 km
Moxtly Highways
Route B
ETA: 55 min
Distsnce: 30 km
Less Traffic
Route C
STA: 1 In 10 urin
Bistsnce: 35 km
Scenis View
Confirm Route

Review & Publish Ride
Route Summary
Pickup: Central Station
Drop: North Tech Park
Date: Oct 26
Time: 08:30 AM
Details
Seats: 3
Vehicle: Sedan
Price: $15
Driver Info
Name: Alex
Rating: 4.9
Publish Ride

Rider
Find a Ride
From: Current Location
To: Destination
Date: Today
Time: Now
See rides

Available Rides
Route: Contral Station to North Tech Park
Driver: Alex (4.9 stars)
Price: $15
ETA: 08:90 AM
View details
Select
Route: Downtown to Airport
Driver: Ben (4.8 stars)
Price: $20
ETA: 09:00 AM
View details
Select
Route: University to Mall
Driver: Chiee (4.7 stars)
Prioe: $10
ETS: 10:15 AM
View details
Select

Ride Details & Options
Route: Central Station to North Tech Park
Driver: Alex
Price: $18
Choose route options from
Standard Route
ETA: 45 min
Eco-Friendly Route
ETA: 58 min
Lower Emissions
Scenic Route
ETA: 1 In
Niee View
Confirm Booking

Smart Pickup & Rewards
CSP: Common Smart Piskup Point
123 Main St, Nesr Park Entrance
Distance: 240m
Start walk
Health & Rewards Summary
Steps
1200 / 3000
Calories
150 Ecal
Coies Eamed
30
Congratulations

MVPs

Phase 1:

a) Exact pickup and drop off location using map and exact address.
b) Push in app notifications for the modification of rides.
c) Auto suggest rides on cancellation via notifications and messages.

Phase 2:

a) Freemium model with limited rides.
b) Short duration plans of 15/30 days with fixed number of rides for hybrid model working employees.
c) FAQs and fast and effective customer support for subscription related queries.

Phase 3:

a) Clear route visibility for the rides.
b) AI generated Common smart pick-up Point (CSP) to meet up at fixed time.
c) Lightweight rewards for walking to CSP.
d) Coins/Star collection as rewards, redemption and discounts policies to be out rolled.

Phase 4:

a) Corporate partnerships and subscription plans.
b) Payment gateway to be implemented.

Metrics to measure Success

1) Ride posting and location mismatch issue

- **Ride edit acknowledgment rate:** % of riders who tap “confirmed” after driver updates details.
- **Post-edit cancellation rate:** % cancellations within X minutes after a ride change notification.
- **Support tickets** per 1,000 rides tagged “pickup/drop/route confusion”.

2) Common Smart Pick-up Point

- **Pickup punctuality:** % riders arriving within ±5 minutes of agreed pickup (or CSP).
- **CSP adoption rate:** % pooled rides using CSP (when available).

3) Rewards and redemption

- **Reward participation rate:** % riders earning coins.
- **Redemption rate:** % coins redeemed within 30 days.

4) Freemium Access

- **Trial activation:** % new signups completing 1st ride.
- **Trial completion:** % users who complete all 4 trial rides.
- **Trial-to-paid conversion:** % users who buy subscription after trial.
- **CAC payback proxy:** average revenue per new user within 30 days (trial fee + subscription).

5) 15/30-day plans (hybrid users)

- **Plan attach rate:** % eligible users choosing 15/30-day plans.
- **Utilization:** rides used / rides included (11 or 27).
- **Renewal rate:** % renewing same plan within 7 days of expiry.
- **Churn:** % not taking any ride in 30 days after plan ends.

North star & KPIs

- **North star:** Successful pooled commutes per active user per week (rides completed without major issues).
- **Supporting**: cancellation rate, mismatch complaint rate, trial-to-paid conversion, 30-day retention, NPS/ride rating.